

FAIZ SAYED

Trade Settlement | Trade Support | Trade Operations Professional

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Investment Banking Operations professional with hands-on experience managing the end-to-end securities settlement lifecycle across Equity asset classes. Proven ability to ensure trades settle on contractual settlement date, maintain books and records accuracy, and resolve fails through root-cause analysis and counterparty liaison. Experienced in Delivery vs. Payment (DVP) settlement, Receive vs payment (RVP) nostro/securities reconciliation, SSI management, and STP enhancement. Adept at cross-functional collaboration with front office, custodians, and clearinghouses, with exposure to DTCC/DTC, Euroclear and international market settlement. Certified Investment Banking Operations Professional with a strong foundation in operational risk management and process improvement.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Associate – Wealth Management Operations — BNP Paribas, Mumbai

Feb 2023 – Jul 2026

Settlement & Trade Processing

- Managed end-to-end settlement lifecycle for Equity and Mutual Fund transactions, ensuring all trades settled on contractual settlement date (T+2) in line with trade details booked in the firm's system.
- Coordinated DVP/RVP settlement obligations with global custodians and clearinghouses, monitoring and resolving trade discrepancies to prevent settlement failures.
- Ensured accurate and timely trade capture for both bank and client positions, maintaining data integrity and 75%+ STP rates across high-volume portfolios.
- Processed, matched, and verified equity and mutual fund trade confirmations against daily blotters and inputs from Relationship Managers/Asset Managers.

Fail & Reconciliation Management

- Spearheaded fail trade management by conducting root-cause analysis on settlement hurdles, optimizing Standing Settlement Instructions (SSIs), and aggressively liaising with counterparties — achieving a 90% reduction in aged fails and significantly reducing buy-in risk.
- Monitored and resolved nostro and securities reconciliation breaks, ensuring firm books and records were aligned with external custodian and depository records.
- Maintained a late/failed trade report, updating reasons for fails and escalating unresolved items to senior management in a timely manner.

Controls, Risk & Process Improvement

- Contributed to the firm's operational control environment by identifying settlement risk exposures and implementing mitigating measures, balancing risk with commercial objectives.
- Collaborated with front office, compliance, and technology teams to enhance client service levels and support new business development initiatives.
- Identified and implemented process improvements to increase settlement efficiency, reduce manual intervention, and enhance STP rates across the settlement workflow.

PROJECTS

DPM Client Category Module | BNP Paribas

- Led end-to-end UAT for client segmentation module; served as final sign-off authority for QA and successfully transitioned the module from testing to production with zero post-launch defects.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to align category definitions with business requirements, improving accuracy of client data classification.

Trade Auto-Execution Enhancement | BNP Paribas

- Analyzed existing auto-execution workflows and identified optimization opportunities, contributing to improved STP rates and reduced manual intervention in the settlement process.
- Partnered with technology and operations teams to implement solutions, deepening understanding of automated trade processing and settlement controls.

KEY SKILLS

Settlement & Operations

- Securities Settlement: End-to-end settlement lifecycle management for Equity; contractual settlement date adherence; DVP/RVP; T+2/T+1 regulatory cycles
- Fail Management: Root-cause analysis, aged fail resolution, buy-in risk mitigation, counterparty liaison
- Books & Records: Nostro and securities reconciliation; ensuring internal system records agree with external custodian and depository records
- FOP Transfers: Free of Payment securities transfers; bank-to-bank/custodian-to-custodian transfer processing; settlement instruction validation and exception resolution
 - SWIFT: Hands-on exposure to MT540 / MT542 securities settlement messages, instruction processing and settlement follow-up
- Asset Classes: Equities, Mutual Funds

Market & System Knowledge

- Depositories & Clearinghouses: DTC/DTCC, Euroclear, international markets
- Settlement Platforms: Olympic, Swift messaging, Neolink.
- Matching & Confirmation: Trade confirmation matching, DTCC Trade Suite

Controls & Process

- Operational Risk: Control environment design, risk identification, mitigation, and audit readiness
- Process Improvement: STP enhancement, workflow analysis, automation initiatives, exception reduction
- Vendor & Stakeholder Management: Cross-functional collaboration with front office, custodians, compliance, and technology teams
- Regulatory Awareness: T+1/T+2 settlement rules, CSDR, internal compliance protocols, fail penalty awareness

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Accounting and Finance — University of Mumbai

2019 – 2022

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Investment Banking Operations Professional — Imarticus Learning

2023